

TOPIC 6: NIGERIAN CIVIL WAR II – MAJOR EVENTS AND END OF THE WAR

1. Major Events

- War began in July 1967; federal forces launched operations to reclaim territory.
- Early Biafran advances (including into the Midwest) were later reversed.
- Federal strategy included blockade of Biafra, which contributed to severe food shortage and suffering among civilians.
- International involvement: some countries and organisations provided relief; others supported one side or the other diplomatically.
- By late 1969–early 1970, Biafran resistance had weakened under military and economic pressure.

2. End of the War

In January 1970, Biafran forces surrendered. Ojukwu left the country; the formal end of hostilities was announced. The war had caused very large loss of life and destruction, especially in the East.

3. “No Victor, No Vanquished” Policy

General Gowon declared a policy of “No victor, no vanquished.” The aim was to avoid revenge, reintegrate the former Biafran areas, and promote national reconciliation rather than punish the East as a conquered people.

4. Summary

The Civil War ended in January 1970 with the surrender of Biafra. Gowon’s “No victor, no vanquished” policy set the tone for post-war reintegration and reconciliation.

End of Topic 6